# Houston Texans Offense: Scouting Report

**Public data.** Built from nflverse (nflfastR play-by-play, NGS participation, FTN charting), mapped onto the PFF GamePBP layout. Run concepts, PFF success codes, yards after contact and receiver alignment are not in this source; see *What nflverse cannot cover* at the end.

**Sample:** 8 games (Sep 13, 2026 to Nov 08, 2026) · 479 offensive plays · Opponents: BUF, CIN, DAL, IND, JAX, LAC, NYG, TEN

**Source:** HST_2026_nflverse_GamePBP.csv · Generated Nov 10, 2026 18:07 · Success = standard yardage definition · EPA = nflfastR model

| 64% | 56% | +0.07 | 48% | 41% |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| PASS RATE | NEUTRAL EARLY-DOWN PASS RATE | EPA / PLAY | SUCCESS RATE | 3RD-DOWN CONVERSION |

| 5% | 9% |
|---|---|
| SACK RATE | EXPLOSIVE PLAY RATE |

## Key findings

### TENDENCIES

- Passes on 64% of all plays and 56% of neutral early-down plays (1st/2nd down, outside 2-minute drills).
- QB alignment is a strong run/pass key: under center they run 67% of the time (n=149); in shotgun they pass 80% (n=315).
- Pistol is a real part of the menu: 15 plays, 33% pass.
- Tell: 3rd Down + Long (7-10) → pass 100% of the time (n=29, 95% lower bound 88%).
- Tell: Shotgun + 3rd Down → pass 92% of the time (n=86, 95% lower bound 84%).
- Tell: 3rd Down + Medium (4-6) → pass 100% of the time (n=15, 95% lower bound 80%).
- Tell: 3rd Down + Extra Long (11+) → pass 96% of the time (n=23, 95% lower bound 79%).
- Run game is built on Middle and Right Guard: 36% of carries.
- Predictability: knowing personnel, alignment, down and distance lifts a defense's run/pass guess from 64% to 75% (leave-one-out).

### STRENGTHS

- Most efficient run gap: Left Tackle, +0.16 EPA/carry, 5.2 YPC, 55% success (n=20).
- Primary target: D. Schultz (#86) (TE), 18% target share, 35 catches for 383 yards, +0.26 EPA/target, 14 first downs.
- Most efficient receiver: T. Dell (#1) (WR), +0.87 EPA/target on 9 targets, aDOT 15.9, 14.6 YAC/rec.
- Lead back W. Marks (#4): 51% of carries, 3.6 YPC, 43% success. Favorite gap: Middle.
- Most total value: N. Collins (#12), 27.2 total EPA on 41 touches + targets (396 scrimmage yards).
- Play action: 20% of dropbacks, +0.23 EPA/play vs +0.18 without (n=62 vs 244).
- Deep shots (20+ air yards): 15% of targets, 49% complete, +0.82 EPA/target (n=39).

### VULNERABILITIES

- Least efficient run gap: Right Guard, -0.29 EPA/carry, stuffed (0 or fewer yards) on 21% (n=28).
- On 3rd and Extra Long (11+) they convert only 22% (n=23); they pass 96% of the time there. Overall 3rd-down conversion: 41%.
- High-volume, low-return target: X. Hutchinson (#19) (WR), 17% of targets but +0.05 EPA/target and 53% catch rate.

**n** = the number of plays (or carries / targets) behind a number, i.e. the sample size. Findings are generated by fixed rules (see Methodology) and include sample sizes. Treat any rate built on fewer than 10 plays as anecdotal.

## 1. Personnel run/pass tendencies

No plays to chart

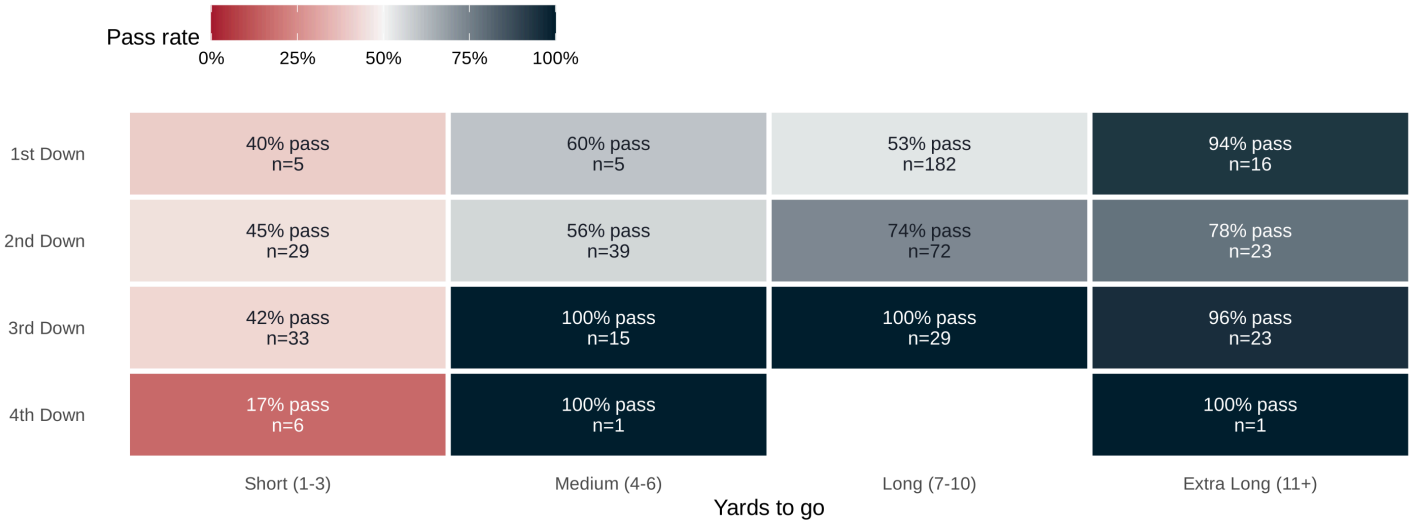
Not available for this data set.

479 plays with no recorded personnel are left out of this section.

## 2. Down-and-distance tendencies

### Pass rate by down and distance

Each box: share of plays that were passes, and n = number of plays in that down-and-distance situation




Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

| Down | To go | Plays | Pass % | Run EPA | Pass EPA | Success |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1st Down | Short (1-3) | 5 | 40% | +0.10 | +0.04 | 60% |
| 1st Down | Medium (4-6) | 5 | 60% | +0.34 | -0.24 | 60% |
| 1st Down | Long (7-10) | 182 | 53% | -0.13 | +0.31 | 53% |
| 1st Down | Extra Long (11+) | 16 | 94% | -0.50 | +0.47 | 56% |
| 2nd Down | Short (1-3) | 29 | 45% | -0.27 | +0.47 | 55% |
| 2nd Down | Medium (4-6) | 39 | 56% | -0.05 | +0.15 | 56% |
| 2nd Down | Long (7-10) | 72 | 74% | -0.13 | +0.11 | 46% |
| 2nd Down | Extra Long (11+) | 23 | 78% | -0.11 | -0.13 | 22% |
| 3rd Down | Short (1-3) | 33 | 42% | -0.27 | +0.90 | 64% |
| 3rd Down | Medium (4-6) | 15 | 100% | n/a | +0.66 | 47% |
| 3rd Down | Long (7-10) | 29 | 100% | n/a | +0.05 | 28% |
| 3rd Down | Extra Long (11+) | 23 | 96% | -0.46 | -0.32 | 22% |
| 4th Down | Short (1-3) | 6 | 17% | -0.48 | -3.08 | 50% |
| 4th Down | Medium (4-6) | 1 | 100% | n/a | -3.30 | 0% |
| 4th Down | Extra Long (11+) | 1 | 100% | n/a | -2.43 | 0% |

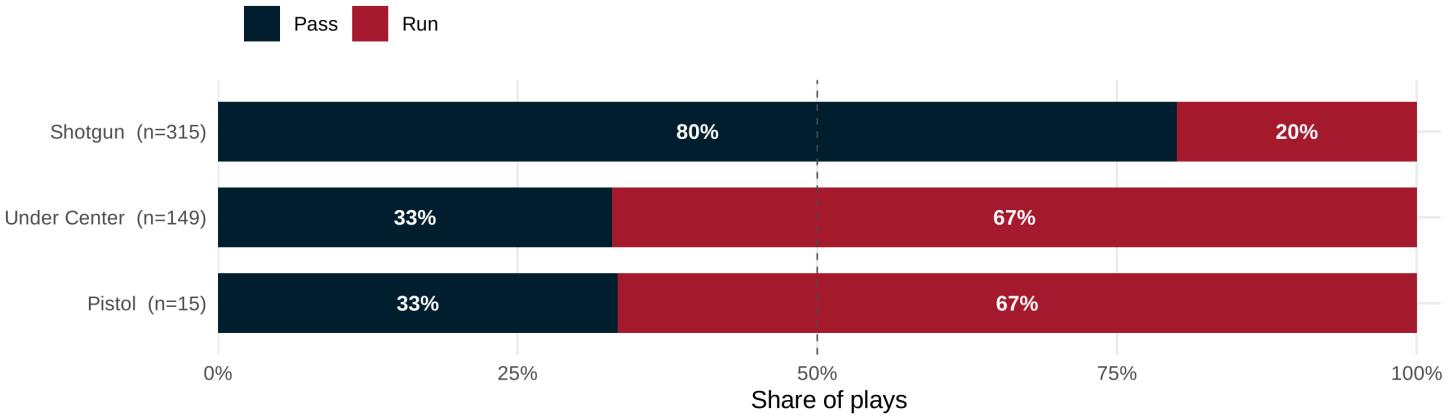
**By field position** (yards from the opponent's end zone):

| Zone | Plays | Pass % | EPA/play | Success |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Goal to Go (1-10) | 29 | 48% | +0.36 | 59% |
| Red Zone (11-20) | 44 | 68% | -0.25 | 36% |
| Plus Territory (21-50) | 162 | 61% | +0.12 | 52% |
| Own Territory (51-80) | 197 | 69% | +0.06 | 50% |
| Backed Up (81-99) | 47 | 60% | -0.00 | 36% |

## 3. QB alignment tendencies

### Run/pass split by QB alignment

n = number of plays from that alignment; read small groups with caution




Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

| Alignment | Plays | Snap % | Pass % | Run EPA | Pass EPA | Run YPC | Pass Y/P |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Under Center | 149 | 31% | 33% | -0.21 | +0.19 | 2.8 | 7.8 |
| Shotgun | 315 | 66% | 80% | -0.10 | +0.22 | 4.1 | 7.4 |
| Pistol | 15 | 3% | 33% | +0.02 | -1.60 | 4.3 | 0.2 |

**Alignment by personnel** (groupings with enough plays):

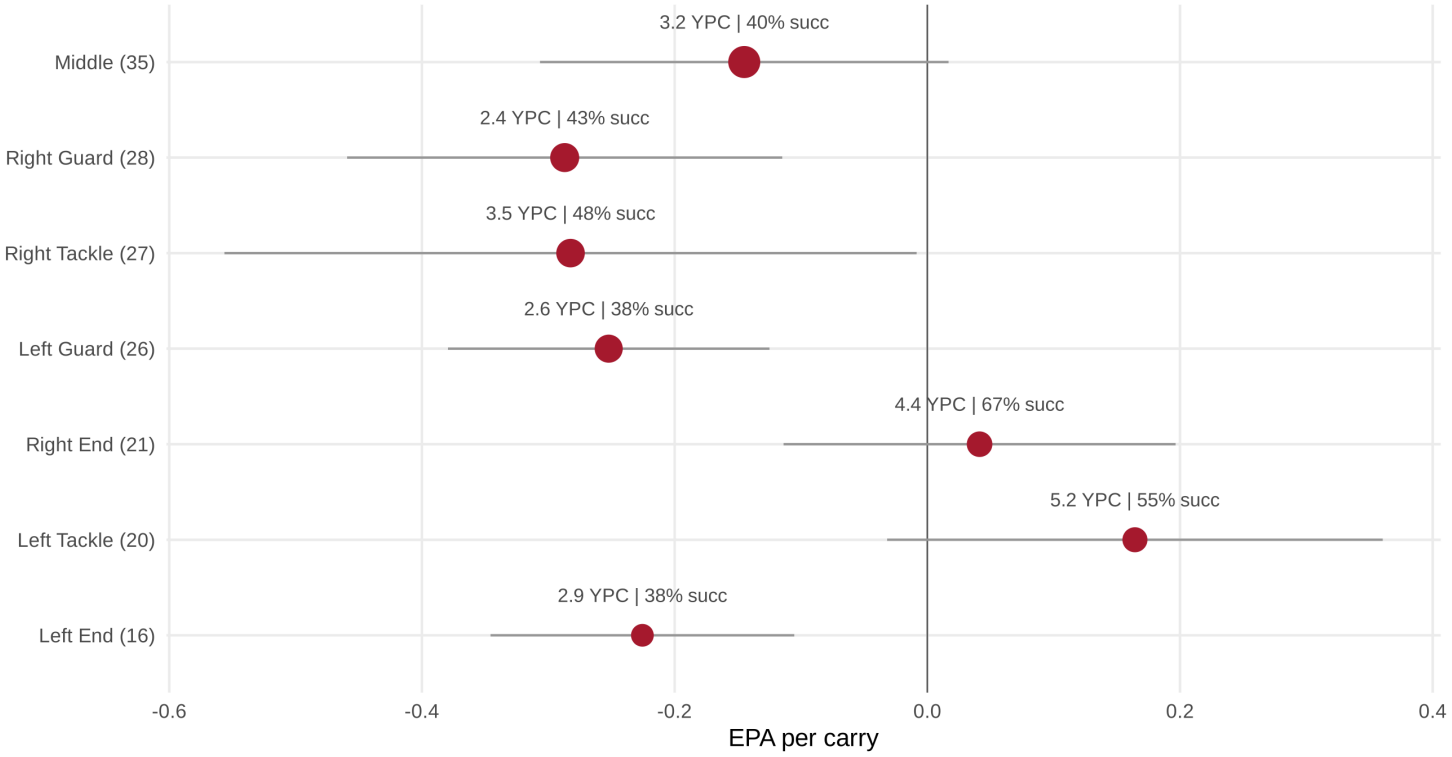
Not available for this data set.

## 4. Run gap and direction: frequency and effectiveness

nflverse does not chart blocking schemes, so runs are grouped by the gap and side the play-by-play records (end / tackle / guard / middle). This answers *where* they run, not *which concept*.

**Run gap and direction: volume and efficiency**

Ordered by carries (in brackets). Point = EPA per carry, bar = +/- 1 standard error



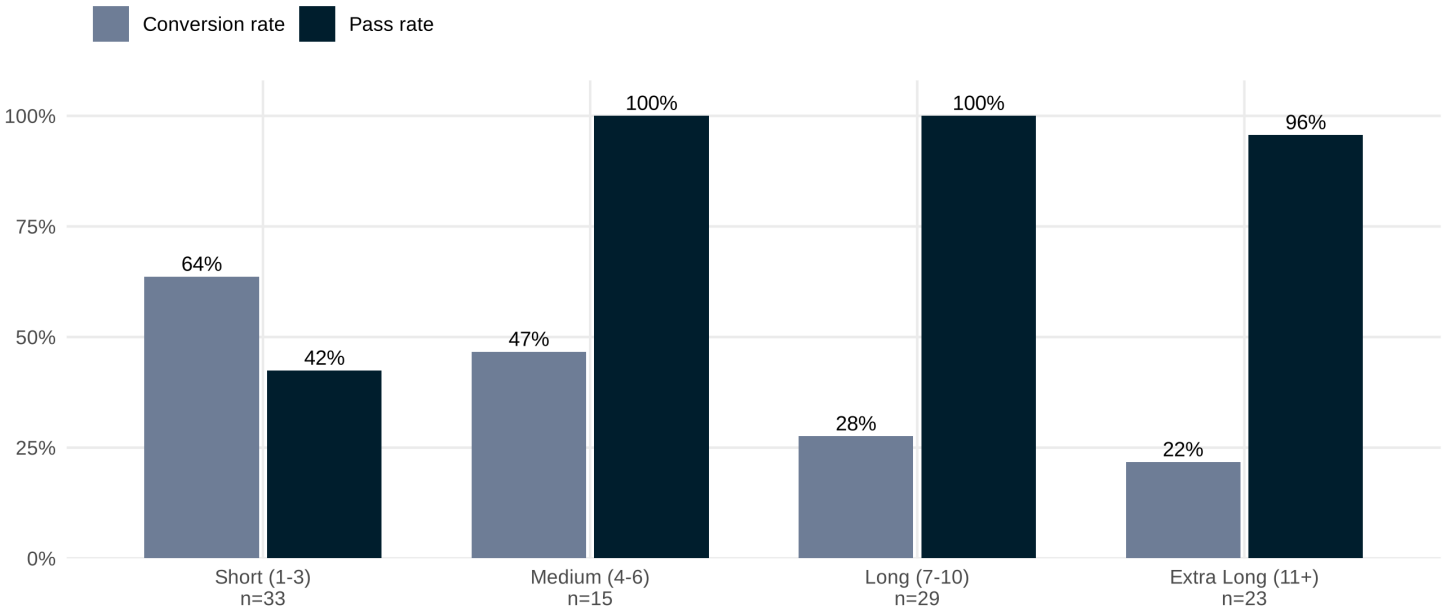

Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

| Concept | Carries | Share | YPC | Median | Success | EPA/carry | Stuff % | Explosive % | Under center % | Top personnel |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Middle | 35 | 20% | 3.2 | 2.0 | 40% | -0.14 | 29% | 11% | 49% | Unknown |
| Right Guard | 28 | 16% | 2.4 | 2.0 | 43% | -0.29 | 21% | 0% | 61% | Unknown |
| Right Tackle | 27 | 16% | 3.5 | 2.0 | 48% | -0.28 | 26% | 11% | 63% | Unknown |
| Left Guard | 26 | 15% | 2.6 | 3.0 | 38% | -0.25 | 27% | 4% | 58% | Unknown |
| Right End | 21 | 12% | 4.4 | 4.0 | 67% | +0.04 | 19% | 14% | 62% | Unknown |
| Left Tackle | 20 | 12% | 5.2 | 4.5 | 55% | +0.16 | 5% | 5% | 60% | Unknown |
| Left End | 16 | 9% | 2.9 | 2.5 | 38% | -0.23 | 19% | 6% | 56% | Unknown |

## 5. Third-down behavior and key targets

## Third down: how often they throw and how often they convert

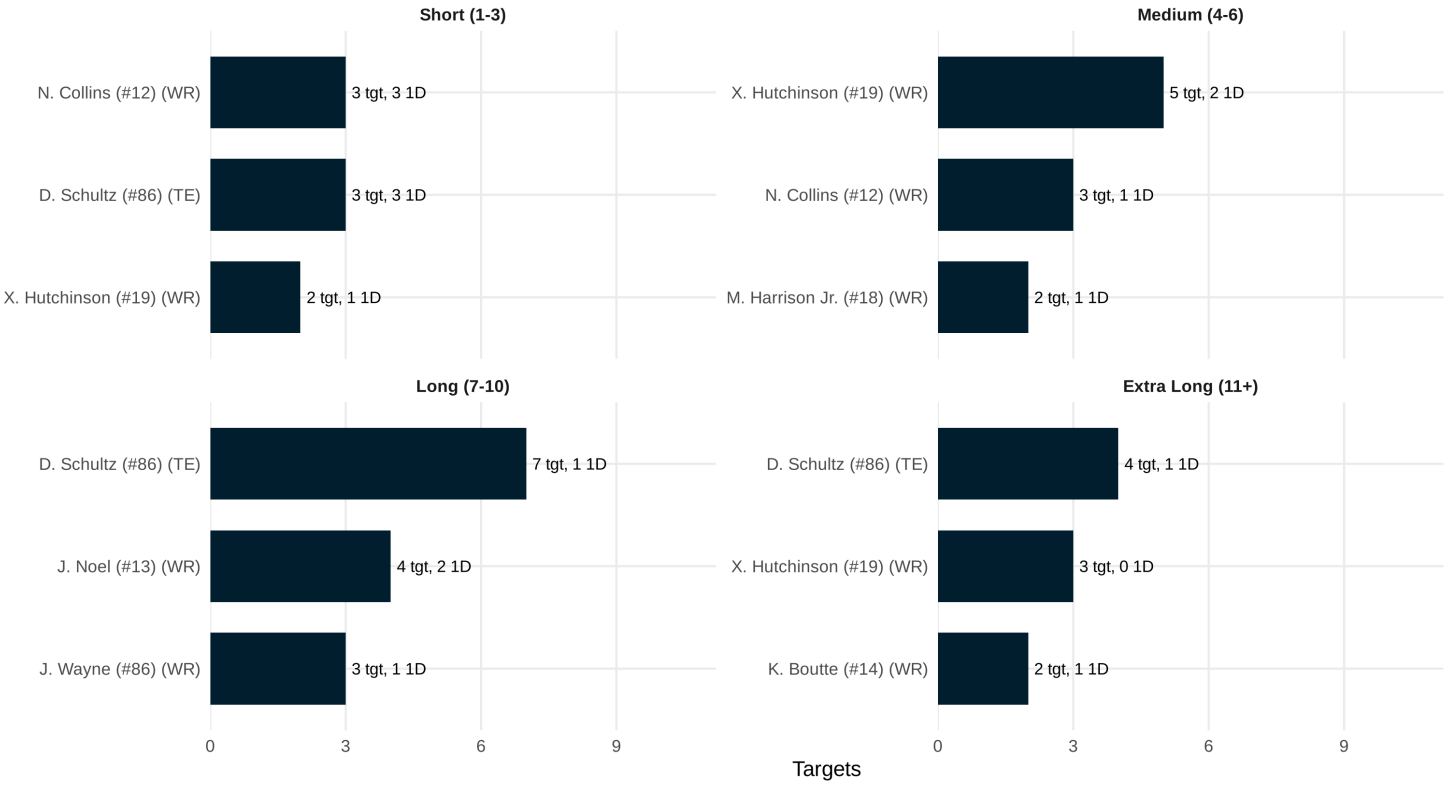
n = number of third-down plays at that distance




Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

| To go | Plays | Pass % | Conv % | Conv 95% CI | EPA/play | Gun/Pistol % | Avg air yds | Sack % |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Short (1-3) | 33 | 42% | 64% | 47%-78% | +0.22 | 58% | 7.2 | 7% |
| Medium (4-6) | 15 | 100% | 47% | 25%-70% | +0.66 | 100% | 12.4 | 7% |
| Long (7-10) | 29 | 100% | 28% | 15%-46% | +0.05 | 100% | 7.2 | 3% |
| Extra Long (11+) | 23 | 96% | 22% | 10%-42% | -0.32 | 100% | 9.6 | 18% |

### Third-down target leaders by distance




1D = first downs gained on those targets. Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

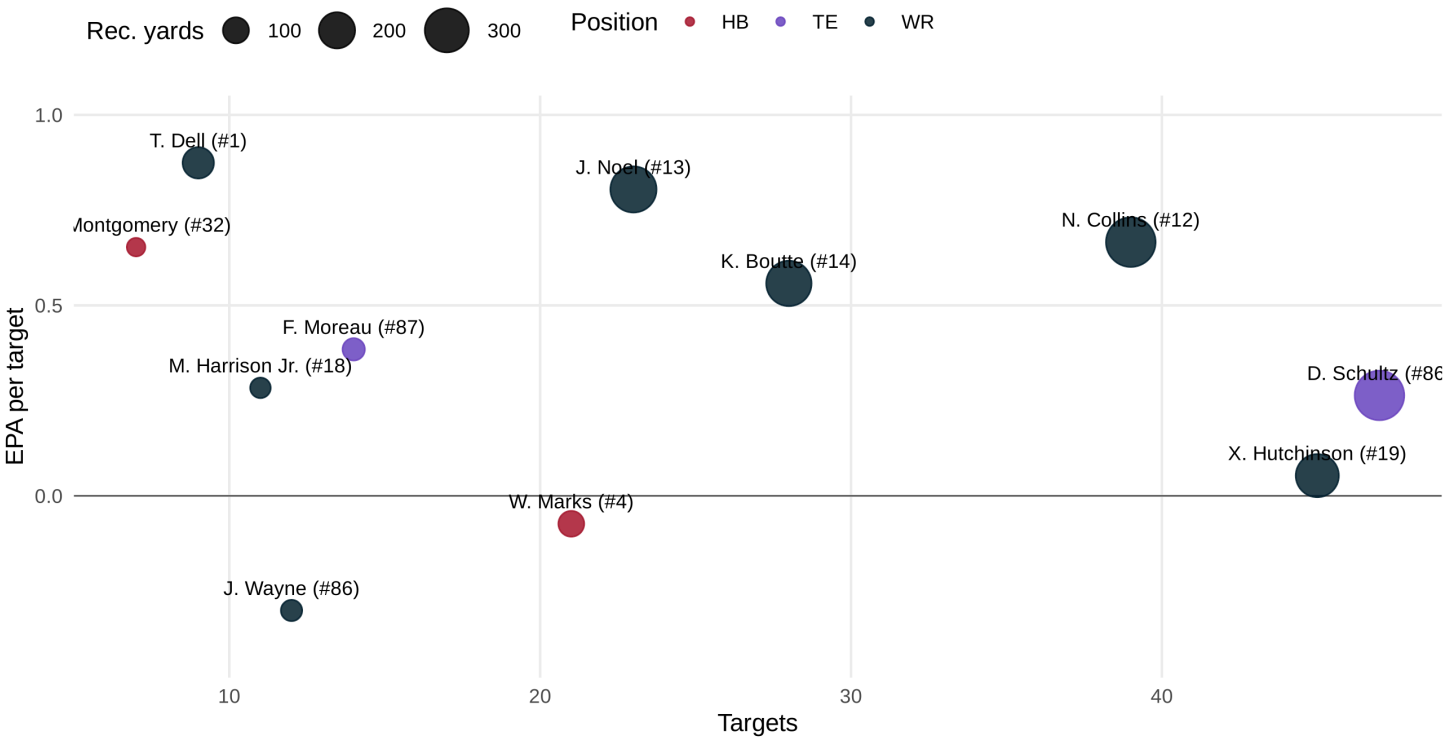
#### All third downs

| Player | Pos | Targets | Share | Rec | Yds | 1st downs | EPA/tgt | aDOT |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| D. Schultz (#86) | TE | 15 | 23% | 12 | 150 | 6 | +0.26 | 6.4 |
| X. Hutchinson (#19) | WR | 13 | 20% | 5 | 48 | 4 | -0.11 | 13.5 |
| N. Collins (#12) | WR | 9 | 14% | 9 | 96 | 6 | +1.18 | 8.6 |
| J. Noel (#13) | WR | 6 | 9% | 6 | 60 | 3 | +1.09 | 7.0 |
| W. Marks (#4) | HB | 5 | 8% | 5 | 44 | 2 | +0.43 | 1.6 |
| J. Wayne (#86) | WR | 4 | 6% | 2 | 35 | 2 | +0.43 | 9.8 |
| K. Boutte (#14) | WR | 4 | 6% | 3 | 101 | 3 | +2.38 | 18.5 |
| M. Harrison Jr. (#18) | WR | 4 | 6% | 2 | 12 | 2 | +0.56 | 10.8 |

## 6. Most effective players and how they produce

## Receiving volume vs. efficiency

Players with at least 5 targets

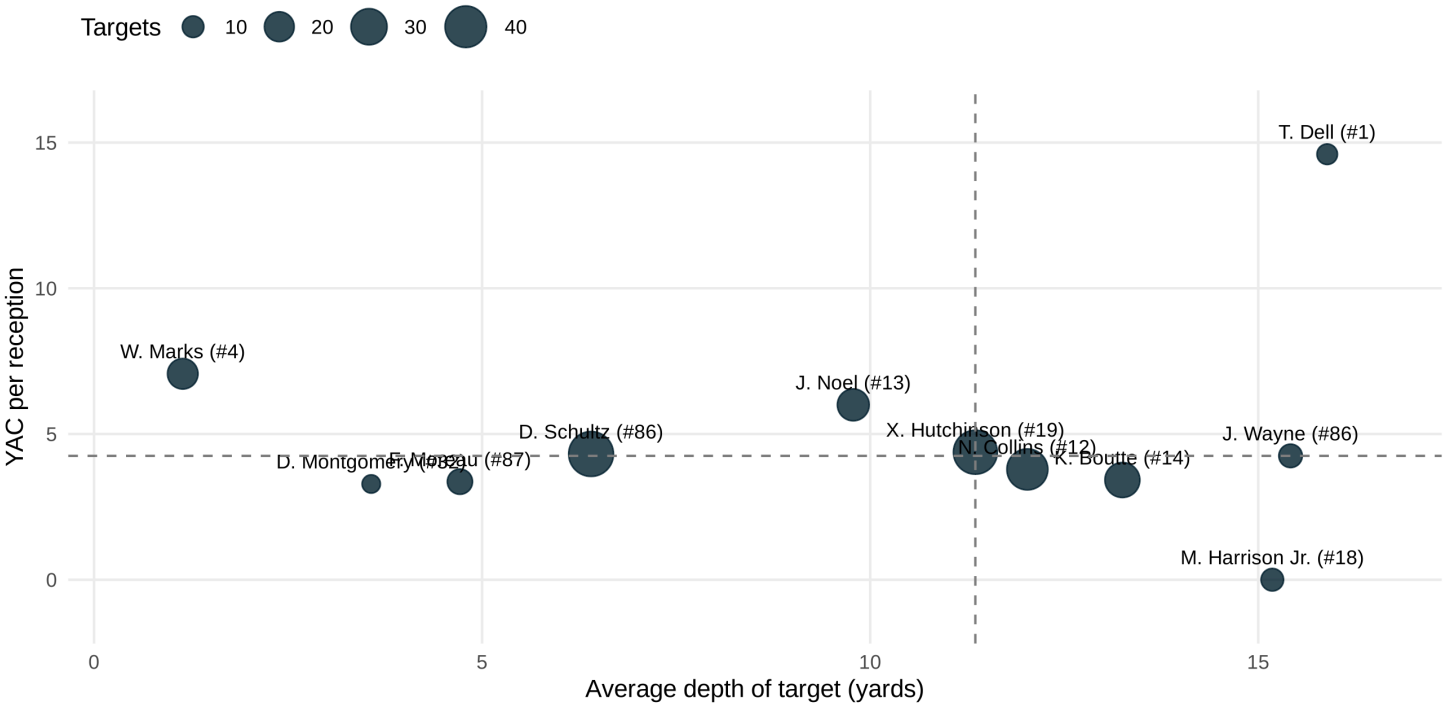



Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

| Player | Pos | Tgt | Share | Rec | Yds | Catch % | Y/Tgt | aDOT | YAC/Rec | EPA/Tgt | 1D |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| D. Schultz (#86) | TE | 47 | 18% | 35 | 383 | 74% | 8.1 | 6.4 | 4.3 | +0.26 | 14 |
| X. Hutchinson (#19) | WR | 45 | 17% | 24 | 287 | 53% | 6.4 | 11.4 | 4.4 | +0.05 | 15 |
| N. Collins (#12) | WR | 39 | 15% | 28 | 384 | 72% | 9.8 | 12.0 | 3.8 | +0.67 | 18 |
| K. Boutte (#14) | WR | 28 | 10% | 19 | 319 | 68% | 11.4 | 13.2 | 3.4 | +0.56 | 11 |
| J. Noel (#13) | WR | 23 | 9% | 19 | 331 | 83% | 14.4 | 9.8 | 6.0 | +0.80 | 12 |
| W. Marks (#4) | HB | 21 | 8% | 15 | 98 | 71% | 4.7 | 1.1 | 7.1 | -0.07 | 4 |
| F. Moreau (#87) | TE | 14 | 5% | 11 | 72 | 79% | 5.1 | 4.7 | 3.4 | +0.38 | 6 |
| J. Wayne (#86) | WR | 12 | 4% | 4 | 65 | 33% | 5.4 | 15.4 | 4.2 | -0.30 | 4 |
| M. Harrison Jr. (#18) | WR | 11 | 4% | 6 | 60 | 55% | 5.5 | 15.2 | 0.0 | +0.28 | 5 |
| T. Dell (#1) | WR | 9 | 3% | 5 | 148 | 56% | 16.4 | 15.9 | 14.6 | +0.87 | 3 |
| D. Montgomery (#32) | HB | 7 | 3% | 7 | 48 | 100% | 6.9 | 3.6 | 3.3 | +0.65 | 2 |
| C. Stover (#8) | TE | 3 | 1% | 3 | 17 | 100% | 5.7 | -0.3 | 6.0 | -0.23 | 1 |

## How receivers produce: depth of target vs. yards after catch

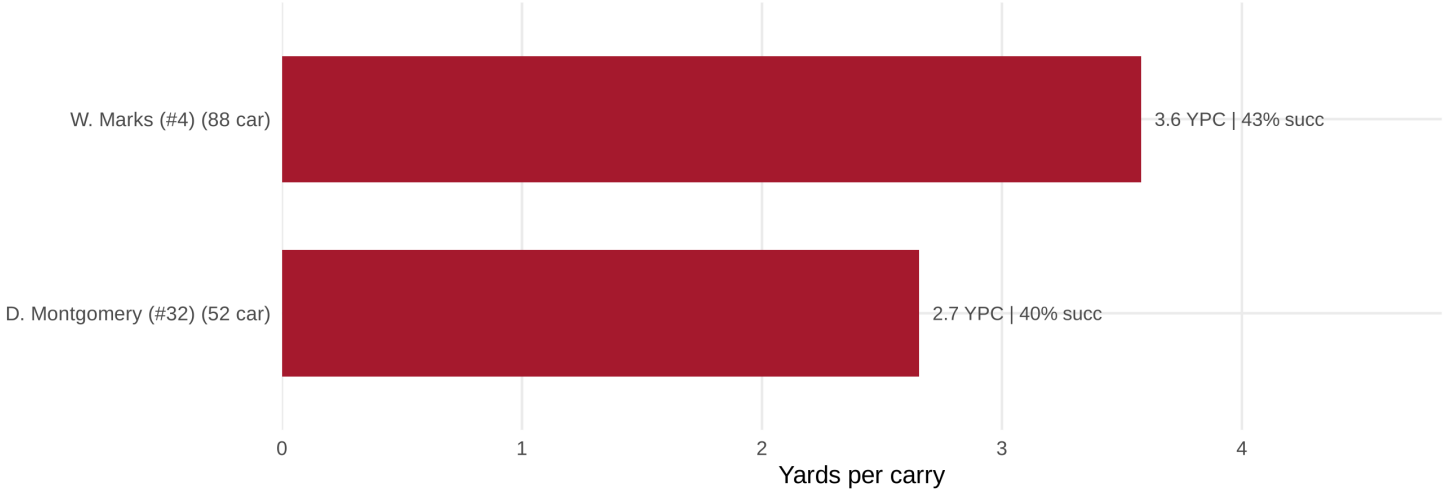
Right = targeted deeper downfield; up = more yards after the catch. Dashed = team medians




Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

## Rushers: yards per carry

Yards after contact is not in this data source, so carries are not split




Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

| Player | Carries | Share | Yds | YPC | Success | EPA/car | YBC | YACo | Explosive % | Stuff % | Top concept |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| W. Marks (#4) | 88 | 51% | 315 | 3.6 | 43% | -0.16 | n/a | n/a | 9% | 23% | Middle |
| D. Montgomery (#32) | 52 | 30% | 138 | 2.7 | 40% | -0.35 | n/a | n/a | 2% | 23% | Left Guard |
| C. Stroud (#7) | 8 | 5% | 13 | 1.6 | 75% | +0.48 | n/a | n/a | 0% | 12% | Left Guard |
| E. Demercado (#21) | 6 | 3% | 16 | 2.7 | 50% | -0.43 | n/a | n/a | 17% | 33% | Middle |
| J. Jordan (#25) | 6 | 3% | 43 | 7.2 | 50% | +0.19 | n/a | n/a | 17% | 17% | Left Tackle |
| J. Noel (#13) | 4 | 2% | 26 | 6.5 | 75% | +0.40 | n/a | n/a | 25% | 0% | Right End |
| C. Stover (#8) | 3 | 2% | 5 | 1.7 | 33% | -0.02 | n/a | n/a | 0% | 67% | Right Guard |
| X. Hutchinson (#19) | 3 | 2% | 14 | 4.7 | 67% | +0.10 | n/a | n/a | 33% | 0% | Left End |

**Total offensive value** (rushing + receiving EPA; QB passing EPA is credited to targets):

| Player | Carries | Targets | Scrimmage yds | Rush EPA | Rec EPA | Total EPA | EPA/opp |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| N. Collins (#12) | 2 | 39 | 396 | 1.3 | 26.0 | 27.2 | +0.66 |
| J. Noel (#13) | 4 | 23 | 357 | 1.6 | 18.5 | 20.1 | +0.74 |
| K. Boutte (#14) | 0 | 28 | 319 | 0.0 | 15.6 | 15.6 | +0.56 |
| D. Schultz (#86) | 0 | 47 | 383 | 0.0 | 12.4 | 12.4 | +0.26 |
| T. Dell (#1) | 1 | 9 | 150 | -0.1 | 7.9 | 7.7 | +0.77 |
| F. Moreau (#87) | 0 | 14 | 72 | 0.0 | 5.4 | 5.4 | +0.38 |
| C. Stroud (#7) | 8 | 0 | 13 | 3.9 | 0.0 | 3.9 | +0.48 |
| M. Harrison Jr. (#18) | 0 | 11 | 60 | 0.0 | 3.1 | 3.1 | +0.28 |

## 7. Passing-game context

| Split | Value | Dropbacks | Share | EPA/play | Success | Y/P |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Play action | No | 244 | 80% | +0.18 | 50% | 7.3 |
| Play action | Yes | 62 | 20% | +0.23 | 50% | 7.5 |
| Screen | No | 288 | 94% | +0.22 | 51% | 7.7 |
| Screen | Yes | 18 | 6% | -0.30 | 28% | 2.8 |

### Targets by depth

| Depth | Targets | Share | Comp % | Y/Tgt | EPA/Tgt | INT % |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Behind LOS | 37 | 14% | 81% | 3.1 | -0.31 | 0% |
| Short (1-9) | 121 | 45% | 78% | 7.0 | +0.30 | 1% |
| Intermediate (10-19) | 70 | 26% | 56% | 10.2 | +0.48 | 1% |
| Deep (20+) | 39 | 15% | 49% | 15.0 | +0.82 | 0% |

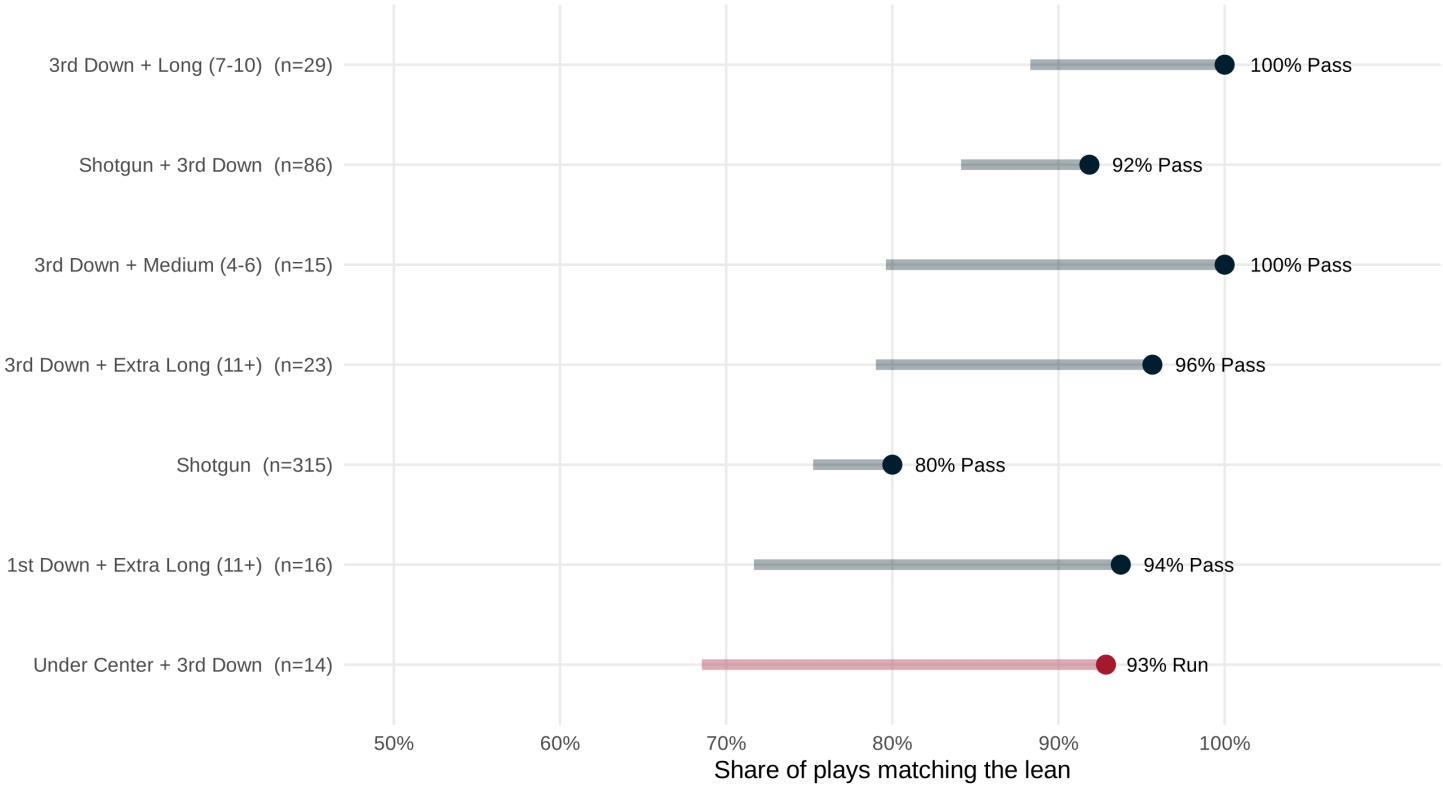
Results by defensive coverage faced (5+ dropbacks)

| Coverage | Dropbacks | Share | EPA/play | Success |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Unknown | 306 | 100% | +0.19 | 50% |

## 8. Pre-snap tells and predictability

### Strongest pre-snap tells

Dot = observed rate; faded bar runs down to the 95% lower bound; n = plays with that cue




Data: nflverse (nflfastR pbp, NGS participation, FTN charting)

Always guessing the more common play type is right **64%** of the time. Using personnel, alignment, down and distance bucket (leave-one-out cell rates) is right **75%** of the time, a lift of **11%**.

## Methodology and data notes

How the sample was built

| Step | Plays |
|---|---|
| Offensive snaps in file | 547 |
| Run or pass plays (drops penalties / no-plays) | 496 |
| Downs 1-4 (drops PATs / 2-pt tries) | 496 |
| Excluding garbage time | 484 |
| Excluding QB kneels and spikes | 479 |

### WHAT NFLVERSE CANNOT COVER (OR ONLY APPROXIMATES)

- Personnel / formation / coverage / routes: nflverse participation data covers only 0% of these plays (it is typically posted after the season), so those sections are mostly empty.
- Run concepts: nflverse has no blocking-scheme charting (inside zone, duo, power ...). Section 4 groups runs by gap and direction instead (e.g. 'Left Tackle', 'Middle').
- PFF success codes (pff_OFFSUCCESS): not in nflverse. Success uses the standard 40/60/100 yardage rule only.
- EPA / EP: nflfastR's public model, not PFF's. Values are close in spirit but not identical.
- Yards after contact: not in nflverse, so the before/after-contact split for rushers is unavailable (yards per carry is shown instead).
- Receiver alignment (slot / wide / backfield): not in nflverse. 'Main align' is blank.
- Personnel is counted from the roster positions of the 11 players on the field (RB+FB, TE). A WR listed as TE on the roster counts as a TE. '(*)' = 6+ offensive linemen.
- Garbage time is approximated with win probability (second half, pre-snap WP below 0.01% or above 99.99%). Calibrated against a licensed PFF sample.
- 2-minute flag: inside the final 2:00 of either half (PFF's 4-minute flag has no equivalent).
- Pressure is NGS 'was_pressure' (yes/no); time to pressure is not available.

Column names below refer to the PFF GamePBP layout the nflverse data was mapped onto.

- **Pass play / dropback:** `pff_RUNPASS = "P"`, which includes sacks and QB scrambles. **Run:** `"R"`. Penalties and no-plays ( `"X"` ) are removed.
- **QB alignment:** Pistol if `pff_PISTOL` is set, otherwise Shotgun if `pff_SHOTGUN` is set, otherwise Under Center.
- **Success (standard):** gaining at least 40% of the distance on 1st down, 60% on 2nd, and 100% on 3rd/4th, or earning a first down. PFF success codes are not in nflverse, so only the standard rule is used.
- **First down:** `pff_FIRSTDOWNGAINED = 1` or yards gained ≥ distance.
- **EPA:** `pff_EXPECTEDPOINTSADDED` as provided. Passing EPA is attributed to the targeted receiver.
- **Target:** a pass play with a recorded receiver, excluding sacks and scrambles. **Receiving yards:** yards gained on completions.
- **Explosive:** runs of 10+ yards, passes of 20+ yards.
- **Field zone:** `ABSOLUTEYARDLINE` is yards to the opponent's end zone (so 1–20 is the red zone).
- **Tell:** a pre-snap cue (personnel, alignment, down, distance, or combinations) with at least 10 plays where one play type reaches 80%. The 95% lower bound uses a Wilson interval.
- **Intervals:** rates show 95% Wilson intervals; run-concept EPA shows ±1 standard error. With samples this small, most differences between groups are not statistically distinguishable; the report shows n everywhere so readers can judge.
- **Garbage time** excluded: TRUE. **2-minute drills** excluded: FALSE. **Personnel "(*)"** marks a jumbo package (an extra offensive lineman replaces a skill player); merged into the base grouping: FALSE.

**Data checks:**

- Player names from HST_2026_roster.csv (nflverse weekly rosters 2026)

Blank numeric cells (for example yards after catch on runs) are expected and listed for completeness.

Reproducibility: source file MD5 9146c67d4ccfba6b92fec60dbc9146a1. Every table in this report is also saved as CSV and in one Excel workbook next to this file.